

7.3 Anti-Spyware

Like anti-virus software, you know you need to have anti-spyware installed on your computer. The hitch is that no free anti-spyware out there is a real-time scanner, that is, one that catches spyware as it's being downloaded to your computer. The Pro version of, for example, Ad-Aware, provides this feature. Nevertheless, here are two anti-spyware software that are known to complement each other well—we recommend you install both of them.

7.3.1 Ad-Aware SE

The installer for this great program is on the DVD, but for the latest updates, visit www.lavasoftusa.com/support/download/ We haven't included the latest definitions on the DVD because by the time you read this, the definitions file on the page might have changed.

The screen starts up showing the status, including which definitions file is loaded, when the last system scan was, number of objects quarantined, and more. You can click “Check for updates now” so your definitions are up to date, and you can start a scan from the same screen.

The Help button is on the left, and the Help is pretty good—of course, it's quite a small file, because you don't really need much help with Ad-Aware! You just run periodic scans and delete or quarantine objects.

The interface, on the whole, we must say, is really simple—as good as it gets. Just click “Scan” and let Ad-Aware do its stuff! Of course, this is not to say it's a feather-weight program: if you want to get your hands



Ad-Aware SE's simple interface. You can do most things right from this screen